



The Garamut
“The message sender”

**Ps Barry Reflections from
 ‘The WORD’!**

For

**PRAYER, PROCLAMATION &
 PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions

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BROKENNESS

Our Focus: Brokenness, the breaking of the outer shell of our lives – for the inner treasure to shine forth.

- * HUMILITY IS THE ESSENCE OF BROKENNESS – IT IS A REPENTANT HEART.
 - * BROKENNESS IS NEVER **SELF-OPINIONATED, ARROGANT, RUDE OR DISREPECTFUL**.
Arrogance - is being proud, displaying a superiority, and self-importance. It involves claiming more consideration, merit, or importance than is acceptable.
 - * BROKENNESS **NEVER QUESTIONS, ARGUES OR CONTENDS WITH GOD –**
ISAIAH 45:9 “Woe to those who quarrel with their Maker, those who are nothing but potsherd among the potsherds on the ground. Does the clay say to the potter, ‘What are you making?’ Does your work say, ‘The potter has no hands’? NIV
 - * BROKENNESS says ‘yes’ to God. You are right and I am wrong” and then takes the lowly path of confession, restitution of wrong and apology to anyone harmed.
 - * BROKENNESS IS PICTURED IN *Psalm 51:17* as a broken & contrite heart –
Psalm 51:17 My sacrifice [the sacrifice acceptable] to God is a broken spirit; a broken and a contrite heart [broken down with sorrow for sin and humbly and thoroughly penitent], such, O God, You will not despise. AMP
Contrite – is the feeling or expressing **remorse** at the recognition that one has done wrong - repentance for sins one has committed - a heart that is broken and wounded because of sin.
 - * BROKENNESS IN A PERSON’S LIFE MEANS – THAT THEY ARE NOT ALWAYS QUICK TO TALK, BUT TEND TO WAIT, LISTEN AND REFLECT FIRST.
 - IN BROKENNESS THERE IS ALSO THE CONCEPT OF **“POURING OUT” - OR POURING FORTH-**
 - Like a heart that ‘spills over’ with expressions of emotion, strong feelings and even tears.
- IN HUMAN EXPERIENCE**
- GOD IS AT WORK SEEKING TO BREAK THE **OUTER MAN – THAT OUTER SHELL OF THE FLESH & CARNALITY** IN OUR LIVES SO THAT THE INNER LIGHT, (LIFE) **MIGHT SHINE (FLOW) FORTH.**

EXAMPLE: GIDEON’S BREAKING OF THE EARTHEN POTS – AND **THE LIGHT BLAZING FORTH.**

- * *Judges 7:16 He divided the three hundred men into three groups and gave each man a trumpet and a clay jar with a torch in it. TLB*
- * *Judges 7:19 Suddenly they blew their trumpets and broke their clay jars so that their torches blazed into the night. TLB*

- THERE HAS TO BE THE BREAKING OF THE OUTER SHELL OF OUR LIVES BEFORE THERE IS THE BURSTING FORTH (or the shining) OF THE LIGHT WITHIN.

- * WITHOUT BROKENNESS THERE IS NO RELEASE OF THE LIFE AND LIGHT THAT IS WITHIN.
- * IT IS IN THIS STATE OF BROKENNESS THAT A CONTRITE HEART IS PRODUCED.

- IT IS GOD WHO DOES THE WORK OF BREAKING THE OUTER MAN OF OUR LIVES SO THAT THE INNER TREASURE – THE LIFE-FLOW OF GOD IS RELEASED AND DISPLAYS THE SPLENDOR OF THE NEW CREATION MAN THAT IS MADE IN THE IMAGE OF CHRIST.

- WHERE THE INNER LIFE'S TREASURE IS RELEASED BY THE BREAKING OF THE OUTER SHELL OF OUR LIVES SO THAT OTHERS MAY ENCOUNTER THE ALL-SURPASSING POWER OF GOD.
- BROKENNESS IS ABOUT US BEING MOVED FROM SELF-SUFFICIENCY TO A DEPENDENCE ON GOD.

- GOD USES ALL KINDS OF THINGS TO BREAK THE OUTER SHELL OF MAN.

EXAMPLE: THE OUTER SHELL OF SELF-PRESERVATION, SELF-RULE, INDEPENDENCE AND SELF-RELIANCE OF OUR LIVES IS WHAT PREVENTS THE DISPLAY OF THE TRUE IMAGE OF THE NEW CREATION PERSON THAT WE NOW ARE IN CHRIST. IT IS SIMPLY NOT SEEN - STILL HIDDEN WITHIN.

THE BREAKING PROCESS IS UNPLEASANT:

Yes, this process of being broken is painful, sorrowful, distasteful and seeks to depose man's authority / rule to be in charge instead of God and this is why the outer man seeks to violently resist such a process.

- THIS SPECTACULAR TREASURE IS WITHIN US – WITHIN THIS EARTHEN VESSEL – our mortal and earthly body. *2 Corinthians 4:7 (NIV) But we have this treasure in jars of clay to show that this all-surpassing power is from God and not from us.*
- People are able to see every aspect of the earthy part of our lives - our character, behaviour, our manner of life BUT are they able to touch the life-flow of the heavenly part of our lives – the treasure that is within.

EXAMPLE: TOUCHING JESUS THE PERSON and not just his garment. Like the woman with issue of blood for 12 years not only touched the garment of Jesus – BUT SHE TOUCHED HIM – THE PERSON HIMSELF because Jesus said, "who touched me" for I know that power has gone out from me." *Luke 8:45-46 NIV*

- GOD'S DESIRE is for this world to be able to touch the real person that we are – the heavenly part of our lives and this can only take place as a result of GOD AT WORK PRODUCING a state of brokenness in us – by the BREAKING of our strong outer shell and allowing inner light and life to shine forth.
- WE ARE ONLY JARS OF CLAY- BUT WE ARE TO SHOW THE ALL-SURPASSING POWER OF GOD THAT IS WITHIN US. *2 Corinthians 4:7 But we have this treasure in jars of clay to show that this all-surpassing power is from God and not from us. NIV*

- BROKENNESS IS THE PATHWAY TO RELEASING GOD'S POWER TO THIS WORLD.

- LET US EMBRACE BROKENNESS WITH A WILLING HEART BECAUSE BROKENNESS IS NOT A LOSS OF POWER – BUT A RELEASE OF POWER – GOD'S POWER.
- "THANK YOU, LORD, FOR CONTINUING TO BREAK MY OUTER SHELL OF 'SELF' SO THAT JESUS MIGHT SHINE FORTH TO OTHERS". – Amen Ps Barry